defined as a state's efforts to increase its own power vis-à-vis a rival or a threat, while negative balancing is policies aimed at undermining the power and position of the rival or an adversary.[16] According to Kai He, the higher the threat perception, the more likely it is for a state to pursue positive balancing (the two forms of traditional hard balancing behaviour), and the lower the threat perception, the more likely it is for a state to choose negative balancing (undermining the power of a rival or adversary). This line of argument fits well with China's policy on India. While China's positive balancing behaviour has been directed at the superpowers, the Soviet Union and the United States, China has regarded India's potential threat to be of secondary importance but still vital enough to pursue various negative balancing strategies aimed at undermining India's ability to be a threat to China's territorial integrity and domestic stability.

Examining China's balancing policies towards India, I will here apply the four strategies Nexon presents in his study: divide and balance, proxy balancing, balancing through public-goods substitution, and binding.[17] These are all strategies that Kai He would categorise as negative balancing strategies. The first is *proxy balancing*, which refers to transfer of resources, in particular armaments, to third parties with the aim of limiting a state's projection capabilities.[18] Kai He calls it arms sales to the "enemy of the enemy."[19] In the case of China, it would seem that its support to Pakistan is a form of proxy balancing vis-à-vis India.

Second, *balancing through public-goods substitution* is a strategy that seeks to limit or reduce the influence of the target state in a region or issue area by providing public goods to third countries equivalent to those offered by the target state or coalition.[20] In the context of China–India relations, we should look for Chinese policies seeking to limit